

Judgment as Mercy, Faith as Trust, and the Mantle That Will Return

Open up to Luke 6. All right, these are pages 62 to 79, and even at that I am leaving out from the last time I read to you. I only read a mere sixty pages, or less, fifty-something. So I have about ten that are not in here.

"Are you going to read us to it?"

No, I just thought I would come out and scare you by waving them at you.

We have Paul in Cyprus now, and he is tangling with the false prophet Bar-Jesus. Judgment is going on, all the reasons for it, the effect of it, and what happens when instantaneous judgment is present rather than absent.

A couple of weeks ago, maybe longer, I had my message ready. It was coming out, and all of a sudden He came on me like He does. I knew it had something to do with travel, something to do with what was coming, and things like that.

So He started in on forgiveness and a series of messages on it. How many have ever taught and know that when something drops down inside of you, it is impossible to go another direction? You can try, but you get pulled back into it anyway.

He got on a subject that at one time was not my favorite subject: unforgiveness. I would have preferred to teach on mountain-moving faith or something, and I did not like the fact that forgiveness was included in the formula of faith.

We started this in Matthew 18 and ended up over in Luke 6, kind of merging what we had learned lately. In Matthew 18, Jesus is talking about who is greatest in the kingdom. We always think in order of achievement: who has the best statistics, who gave the most, who has the biggest chance.

They wanted to know who was greatest in the kingdom. What denoted the corporate respect of the hosts of heaven, the Father, and the heavenly angels? Who was this person who demanded the most respect?

Jesus took a little child and set him in the midst of them. He began with this:

Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven.

Underneath the shadow, we know that the closest thing He could use to type the born-again experience was the innocence a child is born with. When a child comes into the world, he is a little clean slate. He is born in a state of innocence, trusting, teachable, with all these attributes. Particularly, children are quick to forgive.

When Jesus took this little child and likened him to somebody who had been born again, He then went on to warn about the man who receives such a little child and the man who causes one to fall. He said, in effect, that if you have done this to one of them, you have done it to Him.

Then He ended the whole teaching at the end of the chapter by saying:

So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

From his heart. From his heart.

Just about every mighty mountain-moving verse is connected somehow with forgiveness. After you get through saying to the mountain to be removed and cast into the sea, He said the thing that caused it to go was that the person doubted not in his heart. Most of us do not have heart faith, because we have very few mountains that move.

But He gives you a little hint by going on and saying, "Oh, and by the way, when you stand praying, forgive." If you have the capacity to hold harm against another person, you do not have much capacity for mountain-moving faith.

It would be easier for me to give ten percent, give alms for the poor, go kill a sheep, and still hate people, fight, and argue. Under the law, I will kill the sheep, give my ten percent, and plant my crops.

But now all our giving is based on our new nature. In your giving and in your praying, what you give has more to do with you cooperating with the new nature He has given you. Cooperating with that new nature and doing what He asks of you is what causes you to grow.

It is not even the money you gave that changed things in the natural. Do you know God's source? He has no problem barnstorming you and changing your whole world overnight. He can do that. You can walk in one way and walk out another, your whole world changed.

He has the power to come during the night and blow on your circumstances. You wake up, and everything is changed. He can do that.

It is not even the statistical amount you give. Supply He has. Avenues He usually does not. Supply He has, but avenues to get it through He does not. Most of them are clogged up with greed, so they never go to the intended purposes.

But what He loves is your own free-will agency and your fellowship with that new nature in your giving. The effect that brings on you and the change is what He treasures.

At times I will talk about the first times I knew for sure in my heart that the tithe was under the law. The law and the prophets were until Moses. Since that time the kingdom of God is preached, and Jesus said every man presses into it.

When I was sure the tithe was under the law, I came out and basically started teaching the first messages that released the people to operate out of the integrity of their own hearts and what they measured out in their love for God. That is what I came out and began to teach.

You have heard me tell what happened. I think our offerings were cut about in half, and the bills got bigger. Offerings got smaller, the bills got bigger.

Well, that is certainly not the will of God. Maybe it was not, but those of us teaching the principles have to learn to live by them too. If God is not supplying it, you are really not getting anything done that cannot be stopped if the devil kicks up a big enough fuss.

But if your supply is Him, look out, hell, because you are coming through and there is not a thing they can do about it.

So it dropped off. What happened? I got the chance to live by the principles I was preaching.

A long time ago in Medford, Oregon, I told God, "If I had about thirty intercessors, I could just move this whole town and have revival and everything."

He said to me, "Why don't you get them the way you want them to cause the revival?"

I said, "You mean pray them in?"

The offerings dropped off by half, and it took me a while to get over the hurt. I could not even hear Him until I got past it. When He was finally able to talk to me, this is what He said:

"Do you love these people?"

I said, "I do."

To me, the most important thing in the whole world is the assignment He has given me. That is you, and it is Tulsa. I am supposed to get truth and give it to you. We are supposed to take this city, and we are supposed to find out more about the family we call the family of God and our own families, and how we are supposed to walk toward each other.

We are supposed to find this out.

He said, "Do you love these people?"

"As much as I know how."

He said, "Then why don't you teach them out of this? My kids have only returned to where they were really walking in their hearts. That is what they returned to. The rest of it you were taking by compulsion. Anything you take away from somebody that they did not give willingly, they were not being blessed for it anyway."

It is the cooperation of you with that new nature inside, and your willingness to obey and give of yourself anything He asks, that causes the growing. Not because you have the ability to write out a million-dollar check, but because something in you is cooperating with Him.

That is where the growth comes from.

Now just ask me how much forgiveness has to do with that.

You are serving a God who is incapable, in His actions toward somebody, of not having the best for that person in His mind, however it is that He is moving.

"Well, it does not look like that to me."

Nevertheless, every move He makes, being who He is and with the attributes that make the one essence of who He is, everything He does or is forced into doing, in His mind, His movements are the best He can do for whoever He is doing it for.

This is why it is hard to understand God sometimes, especially the way preachers present Him in their teachings.

Things began to change for me when I found out how to open my new nature up to the love of God. By that I mean I found out that my born-again spirit as a son of God has unlimited capacity to reservoir the love of God. Then I found out how to open the channel to God so He could fill my reservoir, which is unlimited.

The more my nature increased in His love, the more I looked over the fence at Him and could understand actions He took that I could not understand before. But I am beginning to.

Take Elymas the sorcerer on the island of Cyprus. We are talking about trusting Him. We are talking about praying the prayer of faith, believing, and being able to settle it on the inside that you can trust Him - not coming with hope and leaving empty all the time, but coming with the hope that faith can put substance to, where you really find out you can trust Him because you found out who He is.

When I first discovered I could really trust Him, I went in wanting to find out about faith so I could get things. But in the course of His indoctrination into His love, I ended up not caring about the things.

When I found out the same faith would enlist the whole corporate structure of heaven to go after a person whose name I gave Him, that changed me. It is not that you cannot have both. But when I found out He would go after people just because He found someone He could trust something in, and I would give Him their name, I had the utmost confidence that once it was given to Him, the whole corporate structure was tracking them down to bring them in to the King.

Hallelujah.

This is what we have come to believe faith is: that God is His own Person, and after all, He is God. Yes, He is God, and He does what He wants. So when everything goes bad, and Aunt Susie dies of cancer, and we get in car wrecks, and all these bad things happen, we think faith is believing in God like Job said, "Though He slay me, yet will I trust Him."

We think faith is that no matter what hell He puts you through, you try to remain faithful and trust Him. But it is not Him putting you through the hell. We think faith is, "No matter what He does to you, try to hang on."

Faith is when you believe what He said about Himself. When something is happening to you that He did not do, faith is not accusing Him of it, but taking your stand and trusting Him that you are going to come out the other side.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

When He said faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God, He meant exactly what He said.

It is not hard for me to believe for somebody. Why? Because inside it is settled in me who He is. I know He is incapable of doing anything but what is best toward you at the time, all He can do at the time.

He is not going to purposely hurt you. He is doing all that He can, which is the best for you.

"I have trouble believing that."

Would you rather believe He is killing you?

So what do we have here? He talks so much about forgiveness. He differentiates between how they operated in the Old Testament and how He operates with us through the new nature.

He spoke so much about the forgiveness we need to have toward one another. Why? Because this is what the new nature consists of. The destructions, the hatreds, and those kinds of things we have toward each other are not in the formula of faith.

In fact, the more you purpose in your heart to do whatever will develop that love on the inside of you, the more your faith overall is going to increase. Everything about your walk is going to increase.

Jesus taught volumes on this kind of forgiveness. In Luke 6, as we kick back in here for a moment - and I am just itching to get hold of this yellow pad. In fact, I am going to.

I cannot get off the statement that faith is not trusting Him though He is slaying you. Faith is taking your stand and trusting Him in what He said about His relationship with you and what He said He would do for you.

I cannot get past this statement that keeps coming out of my spirit: He is always doing the best He can for you and toward you that is in His nature to do.

"Well, it does not look like it."

This is how I can tell what is God and what is not. What happens to me outside of what He said is not Him. Even though it looks at times like He will not do something, trust me, He is doing all that He can.

Since I cannot change Him, I can change me. If He is not doing what He said where I am walking, I am going to go where He is instead of staying where I am.

How many remember the first half of this Ananias and Sapphira letter?

He judges Elymas the sorcerer in this, and Elymas went blind. He was judged at the hands of the apostle Paul. Paul called him a bunch of names and then said, "You child of the devil, perverting the ways of God." Then he said, "You are not going to see the sun for a whole season."

You thought Paul was not very nice. Oh yes, he was. That was extended mercy and love. He was doing the best he could.

Are you ready for this? You might as well be. I am going to have fun anyway.

You can open up to Acts 13 if you want to follow the Scripture when we get to it. Hallelujah. Is anybody having fun? I am having so much fun.

When we start reading, it will be at verse 6, Acts 13:6. But right now, I have kind of changed chapters because this thing is getting bigger than just the teaching letter.

As we continue to follow Paul's life, it was during the same time period that Paul was in Tarsus seeking God and searching the Old Testament Scriptures concerning the promises of Christ that the Gentiles received the gospel under Peter's ministry. Up until this time, they were being excluded from the promises, not by God, but by the Jews.

Many of the Jews who had fled Jerusalem because of the persecution surrounding Stephen's martyrdom traveled as far as Cyprus and Antioch, which is 300 miles from Jerusalem, preaching the Word to none but the Jews only. A great revival broke out in Antioch, and many were being added to the Lord.

The whole time this was happening, Paul was still in Tarsus, about 100 miles from Antioch. Isn't it just like God that many of the same people Paul had run out of Jerusalem were the same ones causing a revival in Antioch less than 100 miles away?

When the good news reached the brethren in Jerusalem that Antioch was in revival, they sent Barnabas, who was a good man, to Antioch. When he had exhorted them for a while, many more were added. Then Barnabas departed to Tarsus to find Paul. When he found him, he brought him back to Antioch, and Paul stayed a whole year and taught them.

Many of the same people Paul had run out of Jerusalem, he was now teaching.

After Paul had taught there about a year, certain prophets came from Jerusalem to Antioch. One of them, named Agabus, stood up in their midst and prophesied about a great famine that would come to pass in the days of Claudius Caesar.

So the saints in the region determined according to their ability to send relief to the brethren in Judea, and it was Paul and Barnabas who would make the 600-mile round trip to deliver the relief to the elders in Jerusalem.

While Paul and Barnabas were in Jerusalem, a great persecution broke out when King Herod had James the brother of John killed with a sword. When he saw how it pleased the Jews, he had Peter arrested and thrown into prison, and an angel supernaturally delivered him.

This time of persecution ended when Herod died a horrible death. He was eaten alive by worms:

And immediately the angel of the Lord smote him, because he gave not God the glory: and he was eaten of worms, and gave up the ghost.
But the word of God grew and multiplied.

Acts 12:25 says:

And Barnabas and Saul returned from Jerusalem, when they had fulfilled their ministry, and took with them John, whose surname was Mark.

Now they are on their way back to Antioch. Upon returning to Antioch, Paul had finished a journey that began with his consenting to and witnessing Stephen's death, all the way until the day of his ordination, which was about to take place in Antioch.

Paul had finished a season where several things had happened. One of them was the good news that the Gentiles had received the Holy Spirit. This was good because Paul's apostleship would be to the Gentiles, and he was entering into his season of apostleship.

Later he would testify in Galatians 2:8:

For he that wrought effectually in Peter to the apostleship of the circumcision, the same was mighty in me toward the Gentiles.

Paul knew he was called to the Gentiles. So the prophets and teachers at the church in Antioch were fasting and praying, and the Holy Ghost spoke and said:

Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them.

Ordination is an outward confirmation of an inward work that was already done, witnessed by the ministries who know.

Acts 13:3 says:

And when they had fasted and prayed, and laid their hands on them, they sent them away.

This brings us up to Paul's first official missionary journey to the island of Cyprus. Having been ordained and sent forth by the elders in Antioch, Paul caught a ship to Cyprus, where he was used for the first time in instantaneous judgment.

This was the second time a man would receive instantaneous judgment at the hands of an apostle. The first was Ananias and Sapphira by the hand of Peter, and the second was the sorcerer Elymas by the hands of Paul.

Let us continue our journey into this unusual yet powerful gift of instantaneous judgment, which is an extension of God's love and mercy.

Acts 13:6-12. Are you ready?

And when they had gone through the isle unto Paphos, they found a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Bar-Jesus:

Which was with the deputy of the country, Sergius Paulus, a prudent man; who called for Barnabas and Saul, and desired to hear the word of God.

But Elymas the sorcerer (for so is his name by interpretation) withstood them, seeking to turn away the deputy from the faith.

Then Saul, (who also is called Paul,) filled with the Holy Ghost, set his eyes on him, And said, O full of all subtilty and all mischief, thou child of the devil, thou enemy of all righteousness, wilt thou not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord?

And now, behold, the hand of the Lord is upon thee, and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a season.

And immediately there fell on him a mist and a darkness; and he went about seeking some to lead him by the hand.

Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, believed, being astonished at the doctrine of the Lord.

First of all, I am so comforted in knowing how far God will reach out for the lost, making every opportunity that they might be saved. When a person knows this with the heart, it does wonders for your faith, especially in the area of your lost loved ones.

If I were Elymas the sorcerer - and to make things worse, Jewish, rich in inheritance, and chosen by God to be among the people to whom He would commit the oracles - what a condition that would be.

Paul said in Romans 3:1-2:

What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision?

Much every way: chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God.

If I were Elymas, here I am with access to the promises of God, but instead I shun them in favor of the sorcerer's power of witchcraft, and I use this power as a false prophet to rise to the position of adviser to the deputy of the entire country of Cyprus, whose name was Sergius Paulus.

What a tremendous act of mercy God bestowed on Elymas when Sergius Paulus, the deputy, called for Paul and Barnabas and wanted to hear the gospel, and Elymas withstood them, trying to turn the deputy from the faith.

When Paul judged him, notice he did not die like Ananias and Sapphira. He was blinded, and only for a season.

The reason is that Ananias and Sapphira were saved. They did nothing that destroyed the foundational truths of Jesus Christ crucified. So in a great act of mercy and compassion, God received them home with Him rather than letting the apostles' teachings be leavened with the kind of greed that appeals to the very core of the nature of the flesh. The love of money is the root of all evil.

But Elymas was blinded only for a season, to give him a chance to repent that he might be saved. I believe in the course of this judgment, Elymas was saved.

If I were Elymas, two thousand years later, I would kiss the ground Jesus walked on for sending the apostle Paul to Cyprus with the rare and powerful gift of instantaneous judgment. I would much rather be Elymas, the man who was judged and ended up in heaven, than Elymas the sorcerer who lived his life out as a false prophet and ended up in hell.

What an incredible gift of extended mercy and love.

And how about Sergius Paulus, who held a major key to the entire country of Cyprus? His salvation had to have affected the entire region. Yet it was because Paul had this mantle on him that he was able to turn a potentially bad situation into victory.

Acts 13:12 says again:

Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, believed, being astonished at the doctrine of the Lord.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

In His attributes, in the nature that makes Him God, He is always doing all that He can, with all that He has, for everyone.

This rare and instantaneous judgment gift that we have been looking at was in the first revivals of the early church. Although it did not follow every apostle to the end of his life, the two it did follow somewhat were Peter and Paul. We know those two were used in this instantaneous judgment gift.

When I sought God and wondered why, through all these centuries, you hear very little of this operation being intact, I understand now that the reason it was not in operation through most of the church ages is because nobody came to the place where He could give them this mantle.

Peter, who walked with Jesus, and the other apostles rose to a place that would be the equivalent of hauling the sick in from Kansas City and Oklahoma City and laying them in a field, and every single one of them getting healed. Every one.

There was such a revival of the agape that many who were present sold all their possessions, lands, and houses. Remember, this was a revival among the Jews only. They were selling their goods and had all things in common.

I have never seen that kind of love reach that level again unless it was some cult that demanded you sell your stuff for control over you. The apostles never asked for their goods. They never raised money. They never received an offering like that. But the people brought it willingly and laid it at the feet of the apostles.

You have the fullness of power and the fullness of the agape of God. Evidently, it is that level of power and anointing that also brings the fullness of the instantaneous judgment gift in - which, by the way, we will see once again in the last days.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

How would you like to go to the darkest place in Africa? Would the witch doctor bother you? Will he bother you?

Just find where there is an infestation of AIDS, where hundreds of the children have it and hundreds of the adults have it. Bring a doctor with you and get ready for revival. By the time you were done there, the witch's staff would have been put down, all the people would have been healed, and you could go your way to do it again by leaving teachers behind to teach them what had happened.

Are you listening to me?

The church at the level we are operating in is doing something, but it is not getting the job done. People just look at us and go, "I do not know if I want to go."

Why don't you give them something to look at?

Hallelujah, Jesus.

What would qualify me to walk in something like that? I wondered the same thing too. It was the mantle of the fullness of that love, mercy, and agape. Until you rejoice in the mercy that rejoices against judgment, you are not even qualified.

Evidently, the qualification to work in that kind of judgment had to be that you first be baptized in that level of the agape and the love of God. These things cannot be used in your personal wars, because God is reaching out maximum for the best of everybody involved.

Paul judged the man in the Corinthian church who had his father's wife - the son who had his father's wife. I am hoping that was his stepmother.

Paul judged that situation from a distance. He said, "I am with you in my spirit."

Somebody says, "See there? Transcendental meditation. He sent his spirit there."

No, he did not. He meant, "You can judge him, but you can do it by the authority I walk in. I am with you in agreement in this. Turn such a man over to the devil that his spirit might be saved in the day of the Lord."

What would you rather have? Would you rather live your life out with your father's wife, or would you rather Paul sent a telegram of judgment? Being two thousand years later, I would much rather have been in heaven for those two thousand years, having been judged by Paul, than be in hell and never have been judged.

Yes.

"Why are you having such a good time?"

Because I am feeding myself.

What do you think happened to him? Something came on him so he could die slowly. He would have a lot of time to repent. As soon as they turned him over, he was no longer under any kind of covering. That was it. I imagine something came on him, and he started repenting, and he got his spirit straight. So when he stood before God in that day, he would at least have his salvation.

Amen.

Then Alexander and Hymenaeus: Paul turned them over. These two judgments were not instantaneous, but they were judgment. He turned them over, and when he went into Timothy, he started leading up to the reason they were turned over. He said it was because of the strife they caused through endless genealogies, meaning they were using the inheritance of the law to prove superiority. He also addressed the love of money being the root of all evil and greed.

He said he turned these two over so that they might learn not to blaspheme, meaning to speak injuriously against the foundation of the church.

Let me show you the effectiveness in the last days. People jump up now and teach anything they want because there is no consequence. In fact, the ones trying to bring us under judgment are the other move, not the moral move. They want us to be judged for our morals because we do not want them to be immoral. We do not want them to legalize immorality in a way that forces us to partake of it.

They are forcing judgment on us because we are not taking judgment upon them.

You know the danger I found when He started pouring His love out on me? That spirit came to visit me that wanted to eliminate the final judgment and hell. The first peak, He really let me have it, the love He has for you. I cried for months and months and could not even get up and preach. The whole time, that ugly spirit was working on me to receive the same gospel Carlton Pearson received, an all-inclusive gospel in which, at the end of it, nobody will be lost.

It was hard for me to discern the difference, and I had to be very careful not to be taken captive to that. So I hung on to the Word I knew, yet God loving you like He loves you.

Now, if Paul came to Tulsa, what do you think he would have done with that doctrine that is opening up the arms of God to an all-inclusive gospel of every immorality that exists in humanity, welcoming them in and washing their feet as though they were in good standing with God?

What do you think Paul would have done?

If Jesus is returning for us, He is coming after a bride that has made herself ready. Something has got to escalate. Could it be that these mantles are going to be restored and you and I are going to see some incredible things in these last days?

We will get to whole regions of disease and receive them into the kingdom.

You are saying, "Brother Roberson, I wish God would use me."

Before it is over, you will say, "Use me? He is working me to death."

What do you think Paul would have done? He would not have been private about it. He would have gotten a public voice and said, "Look, this is not God, and it is not right, and He is not behind it. I am turning this man over to the devil for a season, that he will either repent or go home to be with Him. If you do not think this is God, just wait and see."

If he repents, then we will never know.

Oh yes, you would know, because he would stop preaching that and the gospel would have leveled out.

Listen to me. Through the Dark Ages, hardly anybody was healed. Why? Because there were no preachers with that mantle on them, and because there was no avenue to get it through, He got to heal very few people.

It is the same reason. It is not because He is a respecter of generations. The only reason He lets a generation go is because He cannot find anybody to do anything through.

Well, He sent me off the road, and in my part of the world, I am going to change that. It is going to change in Tulsa, because I am not going to let up until it does.

He comes to teach you what He is teaching me. I expect you to go with me.

You will be glad when we stand before Him in the last day. You will be glad not only for following Him, but for being one of His pioneers on the cutting edge, driving back darkness and judging hell.

"Well, I am not very capable."

You are the one He is looking for. You will not have trouble with His grace. You will not have trouble with His ability, trading your own off for His. He does not care if you stutter, wear your belt crooked, and one pants leg is higher than the other. He just cares if He can get His power and His Word through you.

Looks may get you somewhere in the no-grace realms. Ask me. I know.

The problem with operating in a way that comes right out of the heart is that you can fool everybody else, but you cannot fool Him. He knows where you are. Therefore, you get what is just.

"Is there any chance of me changing?"

Have you ever heard of praying excessively in tongues?

Hallelujah.

One of these days we will preach on praying in tongues.

Listen, I got some of the craziest invitations after He sent me home. They were ones I would have believed for my whole life. Then He said, "Go home." Then they started inviting me.

What did you do?

I came home.

You and I are going to do more by the end of our lives than I ever dreamed of doing had I not changed my course and obeyed Him. So do not let everything surrounding you fool you now.

You learn to operate out of your heart. We are going to clean up dark places of diseases. We are going to take children born in innocence, take that curse, drive it out, and harvest the fruits of revival because we can walk.